PHILOSOPHY PAPER II — PHILOSOPHY OF RELIGION 01 — NOTIONS OF GOD

CONTROL QUESTION AND CONCEPTUAL → WESTERN RELATION MODELS → DIVINE ATTRIBUTES UNDER COHERENCE → SPINOZA: DEUS SIVE NATURA → ADVAITA: NIRGUṆA, SAGUṆA AND → RĀMĀNUJA: ORGANIC UNITY

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

★ PRIMARY CORE FLOW · ★ SUBORDINATE EXTRA · ★ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation q16 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00 CONTROL QUESTION AND CONCEPTUAL AXES

CONTROL QUESTION AND CONCEPTUAL AXES · NOTIONS OF GOD · WHAT KIND OF REALITY IS CALLED "GOD", AND HOW · TRANSPERSONAL ATTRIBUTES · SIMPLICITY RELATION · NATURE AXIS · PERSONAL <-- IMPERSONAL · RELATION AXIS

NOTIONS OF GOD

What kind of reality is called "God", and how is it related to man and → nature: personal / impersonal / transpersonal attributes: power / knowledge / goodness / eternity / → / God-man / transcendence / immanence

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- NOTIONS OF GOD
- What kind of reality is called "God", and how is it related to man and the world?
- nature: personal / impersonal / transpersonal attributes: power / knowledge / goodness / eternity / simplicity relation: God-world

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- / God-man / transcendence / immanence
- NATURE AXIS: personal <-- impersonal
- RELATION AXIS: transcendent <-- immanent cataphatic affirmation + apophatic negation --> analogical control too much affirmation = anthropomorphism

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- too much negation = empty God-talk.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Classify nature, role, attributes and relation separately; personal does not mean bodily or male, and comparison axes are not equations.

01

STAGE 01 WESTERN RELATION MODELS

WESTERN RELATION MODELS · WESTERN NOTIONS · PERSONAL NECESSARY CREATOR; DISTINCT, SUSTAINING, PROVIDENTIAL · NATURAL LAW · WITHDRAWAL; MIRACLES/REVELATION WEAKENED · WORLD IS IN GOD, BUT GOD EXCEEDS WORLD · PROCESS/DIPOLAR GOD ABSTRACT POLE · ETERNAL POSSIBILITIES + STABLE CHARACTER CONSEQUENT POLE

WESTERN NOTIONS

THEISM: personal necessary Creator; distinct, sustaining, providential → DEISM: creation --> natural law --> withdrawal; miracles/revelation weakened → PANTHEISM: God = world/nature

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- WESTERN NOTIONS
- THEISM: personal necessary Creator; distinct, sustaining, providential
- DEISM: creation --> natural law --> withdrawal; miracles/revelation weakened

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- PANTHEISM: God = world/nature
- PANENTHEISM: world is in God, but God exceeds world
- PROCESS/DIPOLAR GOD abstract pole: eternal possibilities + stable character consequent pole: receives changing world and experience persuasion protects

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- freedom, but revises omnipotence and immutability.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Monotheism counts one God; classical theism additionally profiles a necessary creator, sustainer, ruler and moral governor.

02

STAGE 02 DIVINE ATTRIBUTES UNDER COHERENCE PRESSURE

DIVINE ATTRIBUTES UNDER COHERENCE PRESSURE · ETERNITY IMMUTABILITY · ASEITY OMNIPOTENCE · LOGICALLY POSSIBLE ACTS; CONTRADICTIONS ARE NOT OBJECTS OF POWER · OPEN THEISM GOODNESS + POWER + KNOWLEDGE + EVIL · JOINT COMPATIBILITY PRESSURE SIMPLICITY · NO PARTS; ESSENCE · EXISTENCE; ATTRIBUTES NOT SEPARABLE COMPONENTS OBJECTION

DOCTRINE / CLAIM	OBJECTION / PRESSURE	REPLY / RESIDUAL
ATTRIBUTES: omnipotence	aseity omnipotence --> logically possible acts; contradictions are not objects of power foreknowledge vs freedom -- Boethius	essence = existence
eternity immutability	open theism goodness + power + knowledge + evil --> joint compatibility pressure simplicity --> no parts	attributes not separable components objection: can identical attributes permit free, personal relation to changing creatures?

DOCTRINE / CLAIM

- ATTRIBUTES: omnipotence
- eternity immutability

OBJECTION / PRESSURE

- aseity omnipotence --> logically possible acts; contradictions are not objects of power foreknowledge vs freedom -- Boethius
- open theism goodness + power + knowledge + evil --> joint compatibility pressure simplicity --> no parts

REPLY / RESIDUAL

- essence = existence
- attributes not separable components objection: can identical attributes permit free, personal relation to changing creatures?

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Power, knowledge, goodness, eternity, immutability, simplicity and personhood survive only through specified, cost-bearing readings.

03

STAGE 03 SPINOZA: DEUS SIVE NATURA

DEUS SIVE NATURA · ONE INFINITE SUBSTANCE · INFINITE EXPRESSION MODES · FINITE MINDS AND BODIES HUMANS KNOW THOUGHT AND EXTENSION · PERSONALITY, PROVIDENCE AND FREE WILL DISAPPEAR REPLY · SELF-DETERMINED ACTION FROM ONE'S OWN NATURE, NOT ARBITRARY CHOICE.

DEUS SIVE NATURA → ONE INFINITE SUBSTANCE

ATTRIBUTES: infinite expression MODES: finite minds and bodies humans know Thought and Extension depend on → God does not choose to create radically immanent, not a personal ruler outside nature objection

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- DEUS SIVE NATURA → ONE INFINITE SUBSTANCE
- ATTRIBUTES: infinite expression MODES: finite minds and bodies humans know Thought and Extension depend on the one substance

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- God does not choose to create radically immanent, not a personal ruler outside nature objection: personality, providence and
- DEUS SIVE NATURA → ONE INFINITE SUBSTANCE

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- ATTRIBUTES: infinite expression MODES: finite minds and bodies humans know Thought and Extension depend on the one substance
- God does not choose to create radically immanent, not a personal ruler outside nature objection: personality, providence and

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Spinoza replaces a purposive creator with one necessary substance from whose nature every finite mode follows.

04

STAGE 04 ADVAITA: NIRGUṆA, SAGUṆA AND VIVARTA

NIRGUNA, SAGUNA AND VIVARTA · ONE NON-DUAL BRAHMAN · BEYOND LIMITING PREDICATES; PĀRAMĀRTHIKA; SAT-CIT-ĀNANDA · SAGUNA ĪSVARA · PERSONAL LORD; CREATOR/RULER; VYĀVAHĀRIKA; DEVOTION · BRAHMAN + MĀYĀ · EXPERIENCED WORLD THROUGH VIVARTA, APPARENT TRANSFORMATION ROPE APPEARS SNAKE · LIBERATION KNOWS AN ALREADY-EXISTING IDENTITY

ONE NON-DUAL BRAHMAN

NIRGUNA: beyond limiting predicates; pāramārthika; Sat-Cit-Ānanda → SAGUNA ĪSVARA: personal Lord; creator/ruler; vyāvahārika; devotion → Brahman + māyā --> experienced world through VIVARTA, apparent transformation rope appears snake; Brahman undergoes

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- ONE NON-DUAL BRAHMAN
- NIRGUNA: beyond limiting predicates; pāramārthika; Sat-Cit-Ānanda

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- SAGUNA ĪSVARA: personal Lord; creator/ruler; vyāvahārika; devotion
- Brahman + māyā --> experienced world through VIVARTA, apparent transformation rope appears snake; Brahman undergoes no real change

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- ĀTMAN = BRAHMAN --> liberation knows an already-existing identity
- TRAP: anirvacaniya properly marks māyā/world appearance, not nirguna Brahman itself.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Advaita applies indefinability to māyā and world-appearance, while nirguna Brahman remains the non-dual reality beyond limiting predicates.

05

STAGE 05 RĀMĀNUJA: ORGANIC UNITY

ORGANIC UNITY · PERSONAL SAGUNA BRAHMAN, NĀRĀYANA · CIT (SELVES) + ACIT (MATTER) · REAL QUALIFICATIONS OF BRAHMAN · WORLD/SOULS ARE BODY; BRAHMAN IS INDWELLING CONTROLLER · INSEPARABLE DEPENDENCE WITHOUT NUMERICAL IDENTITY · MATERIAL AND EFFICIENT CAUSE; WORLD IS REAL PARIṆĀMA JĪVA · LIBERATION OBJECTION

VIŚIṢṬĀDVAITA → personal saguna Brahman, Nārāyana → CIT (selves) + ACIT (matter) = real qualifications of Brahman → ŚARĪRA-ŚARĪRĪ: world/souls are body; Brahman is indwelling controller → APRTHAK-SIDDHI: inseparable dependence without numerical identity → God = material and efficient cause

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- VIŚIṢṬĀDVAITA → personal saguna Brahman, Nārāyana
- CIT (selves) + ACIT (matter) = real qualifications of Brahman
- ŚARĪRA-ŚARĪRĪ: world/souls are body; Brahman is indwelling controller

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- APṚTHAK-SIDDHI: inseparable dependence without numerical identity
- God = material and efficient cause
- world is real PARIṆĀMA jīva --> dependence --> bhakti --> prapatti --> liberation objection: do bodily defects taint God?

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- reply: defects belong to controlled body.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: High-value transition: Real manifestation/pariṇāma (real transformation); bhakti and prapatti; liberation is service/communion, not absorption.

06

STAGE 06 NYĀYA AND HINDU DIVINE PLURALITY

NYĀYA AND HINDU DIVINE PLURALITY · NYĀYA ĪSVARA · GOD + SELVES + ATOMS + SPACE/TIME ARE REAL · GOD IS EFFICIENT CAUSE; ETERNAL ATOMS ARE MATERIAL CAUSES · DIVINE COORDINATION · FITTING RESULTS; SELVES REMAIN DISTINCT · "IS HINDUISM POLYTHEISTIC?" POLYTHEISM · ṚGVEDA 1.164.46

NYĀYA ĪSVARA: God + selves + atoms + space/time are real

God is efficient cause; eternal atoms are material causes karma/adṛṣṭa --> divine coordination --> fitting → "IS HINDUISM POLYTHEISTIC?" polytheism → Rgveda 1.164.46: reality is one; sages speak of it variously verdict: many-deity practice, one-deity praise

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- NYĀYA ĪSVARA: God + selves + atoms + space/time are real
- God is efficient cause; eternal atoms are material causes karma/adṛṣṭa --> divine coordination --> fitting results; selves remain distinct

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- "IS HINDUISM POLYTHEISTIC?" polytheism
- Rgveda 1.164.46: reality is one; sages speak of it variously verdict: many-deity practice, one-deity praise, sectarian supremacy and

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- Upanisadic monism coexist; one label cannot exhaust all levels.
- NYĀYA ĪSVARA: God + selves + atoms + space/time are real

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Nyāya profiles one eternal omniscient incorporeal efficient cause and karmic governor; proofs and anti-creator replies belong elsewhere.

07

STAGE 07 COMPARATIVE GOD-WORLD-MAN MATRIX

COMPARATIVE GOD-WORLD-MAN MATRIX · SYSTEM GOD-WORLD GOD-MAN · THEISM CREATOR AND SUSTAINER WORSHIP, PROVIDENCE, GRACE · DEISM CREATOR WHO WITHDRAWS REMOTE RATIONAL SOURCE · SPINOZA GOD · NATURE PERSON IS FINITE MODE · ADVAITA WORLD IS VIVARTA ĀTMAN · RĀMĀNUJA WORLD IS GOD'S REAL BODY DISTINCT YET INSEPARABLY

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EVALUATION / TRAP
SYSTEM GOD-WORLD GOD-MAN	Spinoza God = Nature person is finite mode	Nyāya God orders eternal atoms distinct soul under moral governance ultimate cause need not be physical: spatial/material dependence limits ultimacy
Theism creator and sustainer worship, providence, grace	Advaita world is vivarta ātman = Brahman	pantheism and Rāmānuja qualify this without requiring an anthropomorphic body.
Deism creator who withdraws remote rational source	Rāmānuja world is God's real body distinct yet inseparably dependent	

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

- SYSTEM GOD-WORLD GOD-MAN
- Theism creator and sustainer worship, providence, grace
- Deism creator who withdraws remote rational source

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- Spinoza God = Nature person is finite mode
- Advaita world is vivarta ātman = Brahman
- Rāmānuja world is God's real body distinct yet inseparably dependent

EVALUATION / TRAP

- Nyāya God orders eternal atoms distinct soul under moral governance ultimate cause need not be physical: spatial/material dependence limits ultimacy
- pantheism and Rāmānuja qualify this without requiring an anthropomorphic body.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: God-models must be compared on common axes of world-relation, human freedom and worship, not by labels considered in isolation.

08

STAGE 08 EXAMINER TRAPS AND PYQ ROUTES

EXAMINER TRAPS AND PYQ ROUTES · SPATIALLY REMOTE IMMANENT · NON-EXISTENT APṚTHAK-SIDDHI · NYĀYA GOD · EFFICIENT CAUSE · PYQ ROUTES PERSONAL/IMPERSONAL · THEISM + SPINOZA + SAGUṆA/NIRGUṆA · DEVOTION FREEDOM/GOD

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EVALUATION / TRAP
TRAPS: personal != anthropomorphic	nirguna != non-existent apṛthak-siddhi != identity	PYQ ROUTES personal/impersonal --> theism + Spinoza + saguna/nirguna
transcendent != spatially remote immanent != pantheistic	Nyāya God = efficient cause	Spinoza --> substance --> attributes --> modes --> necessity --> criticism
pantheism != panentheism	monism != monotheism	Rāmānuja --> cit/acit --> body-soul --> apṛthak-siddhi --> devotion freedom/God --> foreknowledge problem --> named solutions --> qualified verdict.

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

- TRAPS: personal != anthropomorphic
- transcendent != spatially remote immanent != pantheistic
- pantheism != panentheism

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- nirguna != non-existent apṛthak-siddhi != identity
- Nyāya God = efficient cause
- monism != monotheism

EVALUATION / TRAP

- PYQ ROUTES personal/impersonal --> theism + Spinoza + saguna/nirguna
- Spinoza --> substance --> attributes --> modes --> necessity --> criticism
- Rāmānuja --> cit/acit --> body-soul --> apṛthak-siddhi --> devotion freedom/God --> foreknowledge problem --> named solutions --> qualified verdict.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Analogy and symbol can preserve reference without anthropomorphic or gendered literalism; non-dual Brahman is not classical personal God.

09

STAGE 09 ANSWER SPINE AND QUALIFIED CONCLUSION

ANSWER SPINE AND QUALIFIED CONCLUSION · DEFINE EXACT GOD-CONCEPT · STATE METAPHYSICAL MODEL · EXPLAIN GOD-WORLD AND GOD-MAN RELATIONS · USE EXACT SCHOOL TERMINOLOGY · STRONGEST OBJECTION · STRONGEST REPLY · SAME-AXIS COMPARISON

define exact God-concept → state metaphysical model → explain God-world and God-man relations → use exact school terminology → strongest objection → strongest reply → same-axis comparison → qualified philosophical verdict → God is a family of models: perfect person, infinite substance, non-dual consciousness, organic unity or

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- define exact God-concept → state metaphysical model
- explain God-world and God-man relations → use exact school terminology

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- strongest objection → strongest reply → same-axis comparison
- qualified philosophical verdict

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- God is a family of models: perfect person, infinite substance, non-dual consciousness, organic unity or intelligent ordering.
- Adequacy turns on nature + attributes + relations coherence: whether ultimacy best preserves agency, unity, devotion, independence, moral

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Final verdict: "The notion of God is not a single universal concept but a family of metaphysical models.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · ENRICHMENT — EXTRA DEPTH, NEVER A PREREQUISITE FOR THE · WESTERN AND ABRAHAMIC REFERENCE STANDARDS · INDIAN SCHOOL-SPECIFIC COMPARISON · CRITIQUE, LANGUAGE AND PRACTICAL CONSEQUENCES · EXTERNAL PHILOSOPHY OF RELIGION DOSSIER · TOPIC 1 — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED] · CREATION EX NIHILO MEANS DEPENDENCE ON DIVINE AGENCY WITHOUT

OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS

- ADVANCED / ENRICHMENT — extra depth, never a prerequisite for the verified PYQs
- Western and Abrahamic Reference Standards
- Indian School-Specific Comparison
- Critique, Language and Practical Consequences

ADVANCED OBJECTION

- External Philosophy of Religion dossier: Topic 1 — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]
- Creation ex nihilo means dependence on divine agency without independent primordial material; "nothing" is not a material cause.
- Emanation treats finite reality as proceeding from the source, often with stronger necessity and weaker choice.
- Panentheism places the world within divine life while holding that God exceeds it.

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

- Efficient causation need not require physical manifestation.
- Ramanuja's body-language expresses dependence and governance, not a finite divine organism.
- Augustine: creator, eternal truth, goodness and providential personal relation.
- Anselm: perfect-being grammar; use its attribute implications here, not the proof.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels